Application Rubric

The following rubric is to be used for scoring written applications.

In general, I made it so that getting a 3 is like meeting the “hiring bar”, while 4 would be like a first-round draft pick equivalent. 2’s are just mid, and 1’s are no good.

	Points			
	1	2	3	4
Interest in the club	Applicant has generic responses and puts in the bare minimum into for responses, such as one or two line answers for why they want to join.	Applicant seems to have put in at least some effort into constructing a response to why they want to join, but reasons are vague and unclear.	Applicant has well-written reasons for wanting to join Hack4Impact. Things preventing a 3 from a 4 could be if the applicant’s reasons could be satisfied at other clubs and not mentioning anything Hack4Impact specific.	Applicant has clear and well-written reasons for wanting to join Hack4Impact specifically. Things to look for would be mentioning past projects or information from our website (showing initiative in looking up our website). If they’ve attended one of our past events, that

				would be a plus as well.
Interest in social good	Applicant doesn't mention the social impact of the club - clearly just wants to use Hack4Impact as a resume booster.	Applicant mentions social impact but reasons are vague and answers to specific social initiatives seem generic and insincere.	Applicant has detailed response to social initiatives and shows passion for doing social good.	Applicant goes above and beyond on social initiatives that they are passionate about. Applicant shows passion about using their abilities to do good in the community, and has shown past initiative in terms of giving back to the community.
Technical Expertise (Engineer, Bootcamp, Sourcing)	Applicant does not have any experience with web dev or any relevant web dev projects. Applicant shows little interest in growing and learning as an engineer.	Applicant has somewhat relevant experience, and shows drive and passion in learning and improving.	Applicant has good relevant experience. Something stopping a 3 from a 4 would be no prior experience working on teams.	Applicant has exemplary experience that would translate well to a Hack4Impact team (web dev personal projects, SWE internships). Applicant demonstrates through prior experience that they have worked proficiently on software teams (Agile) as well as exhibit great

				communication skills through the written application.
Technical Expertise (Tech Lead)	Applicant does not earn a 3 or 4 in the engineer criterion.	Applicant is an above average engineer, but may need to be paired with another more experienced tech lead on a team.	Applicant is an exemplary engineer and is ready to take on a larger role. Things stopping a 3 from being a 4 is a lack of in-field experience leading a SWE team.	Applicant has shown exemplary ability in writing and maintaining clean code (through GitHub or previous experience). Applicant has excelled at a similar leadership role on a SWE team previously. Applicant demonstrates understanding of what good code is like and has shown to be able to make good technical decisions on what technical stack to choose.

Technical Expertise (Designers)	Applicant demonstrates no projects to back up their artistic ability.	Applicant has adequate ability in terms of creating and designing, but designs are not outstanding.	Applicant is creative and has some artistic ability. Things separating a 3 from a 4 would be lack of experience in digital design or lack of clear communication in written responses.	Applicant is creative and has great artistic ability (exemplified through projects / portfolios). Applicant is a great fit, having prior experience using Figma or other Figma-esque tools.
Technical Expertise (PMs)	Applicant does not show that they understand the scope and responsibility of the role of a PM through their responses.	Applicant shows moderate ability in organization and communication - would be able to be a PM only if paired with a more experienced co-PM.	Applicant shows good ability in organization and communication. Things stopping a three from a four could be inexperience with working on a rigorous software development team.	Applicant clearly understands what is needed from a PM, has exemplary communication skills and has proven to be able to work proficiently in software team environments.
NPO Experience (PR & O — Outreach Coordinator ONLY)	Applicant does not show that they understand the scope and responsibility of the role of an NPO through their responses.	Applicant has an adequate understanding of NPOs and their function within our society. They have a minimal amount of experience with NPOs.	Applicant has an adequate understanding of NPOs and how they incorporate into Hack4Impacts mission. They have substantial knowledge and experience with NPOs. Little to no hands-on	Applicant has an exceptional understanding of NPOs and how they can work in unison with Hack4Impact and our goals. They have a complete

			experience with NPOs in their personal lives.	understanding of NPOs on all-levels and varied hands-on experience with them in their personal lives.
Communication & Writing Skills (PR & O)	Applicant does not demonstrate the necessary writing and/or communication skills required for a professional setting.	Applicant possesses coherent but non-professional writing skills and/or struggles with communicating openly and effectively.	Applicant makes clear and sound statements/arguments throughout their writing and within their communication. They lack charisma and personality within their communication.	Applicant consistently sounds professional throughout their writing and communication. Maintains a professional level of charisma within their communication.
Marketing Expertise (PR & O — Social Media Manager ONLY)	Applicant has no relevant experience with social media or content creation and provides no clear understanding of the platforms or goals of social media for a club/org.	Applicant has limited experience with social media or content creation. They may have helped run accounts or contributed to posts but do not explain their role clearly.	Applicant has relevant experience managing social media or content for a club/org. They provide some explanation of platforms used and content type.	Applicant has strong, hands-on experience creating and managing social media or video content. They show clear understanding of audience engagement, platform strategy, or brand storytelling.

Technical Application Assessment Rubric

The following rubric is to be used for scoring technical assessment applications for those applying for the tech lead or engineer roles.

The key difference between coding practices and coding style is that coding practices addresses the efficiency/practicality of the code. Code should be efficient and done properly (for lack of a better term). For example, hover interactions should be created using .hover in css.
On the other hand, coding style addresses the stylistic choices made in code. This involves things such as readability, class names, usage of accessibility mechanics (such as “alt” tags in images), mobile responsiveness, and other things of that nature.

	Points			
	1	2	3	4
Functionality	The code barely functions. Clicking buttons doesn’t do anything.	The code somewhat functions. There may be large errors, such as all artists display at once, but there is some level of functionality.	It is mostly functional with a 1-2 minor errors (usually the artists do not cycle properly).	Code is fully functional. The buttons do what they are supposed to. The artists cycle properly when the buttons are clicked. If the cursor is not a pointer when the button is hovered, give a 3.5.
Visual	The design is not reflected in the submission. Elements are missing or completely different from thwe design.	The page looks somewhat like the Figma. Major discrepancies exist in the design, but all features are displayed. Elements may be incorrectly	Different from the Figma in minor ways (e.g. corners not rounded, colors off). Objects are still oriented correctly on the page. Sizing and	Looks almost identical to the Figma design. Colors are correct. Hover interactions and selected buttons look correct. Images are correctly sized.

		aligned or sized. The key difference between a 2 and a 3 is that a 2 demonstrates that there was a large visual error that was clearly not addressed (such as the arrows being just lines instead of 2D).	spacing should roughly match the Figma. A 3 usually indicates a minor spacing or margin errors, rather than any major error. A 3 can also be given if the components are different sizes for different artists.	If the sizing is a bit big, and the page has a scrollbar it can still be given a 4 (if the sizing is comically big, maybe put it as a 3. If the top or bottom of the page has no margins, then give a 3.5.
Coding Practices	The code is full of bad practices. Lots of hard coding. Solutions are comically overcomplicated.	Values or data are hard coded. Solutions do not take advantage of key React features like state and components. Things to Look Out For: Frequent in-line styling for style that does not change. Frequent use of “position: absolute”.	The code is effective but could be more efficient. Solutions are more complicated than necessary. Code is repeated when not necessary (such as in the CSS for hovering an element). Things that Could Indicate 3: - No usage of props - 1-2 instances of position: absolute	The code is minimal to accomplish the required functionality. React states and parameters are used effectively to store and pass down information. The data is handled responsively so that if the data files were to be altered the code would still work perfectly. Things to Look For: - Usage of .map when displaying an artist’s songs - Usage of the

			- 1-2 instances of in-line styling	modulus operator to cycle between artists If either of those things are missing, give it a 3.5 instead of a 4.
Coding Style	The code cannot be understood.	The code is hard to read. There might be weird chains of parentheses or brackets. The class names don't really make sense.	The code is mostly easy to read. There might be some really long lines or some weird class names, but it's good for the most part. Things that Could Indicate a 3: - There might be components only containing a few lines (shouldn't really be a component). - On the other hand, there might not be enough components. Maybe one file is really big and contains too much code to the point where it affects the readability of the code.	The code is easy to read. There is good documentation and comments when appropriate. The class names are chosen well. If only a couple class names are chosen badly, give it a 3.5 or 3 depending on how many class names are bad.

			- There might be some functions which don't need to be separate functions (such as a function whose only purpose is to setState). - A few bad class names	
Bonus Things to Note (not worth points)	- Images have alt tags that actually describes what the image is (make sure it's not just the word "image") - Comments - Mobile Responsiveness			

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Role Specific Things to Look For (According to respective directors):

General:

- Sahil:
  - Do they care about club? Look for mentions of projects, mentions of NPOs, and details rather than just padding words.
  - Have they done any social good? Is the social good that they mentioned a byproduct of whatever they are doing or was that the main purpose? Is it actually something which takes time/effort? Does it help people other than just their close family/friends?
  - How time-consuming are their other time commitments?

Salma + Yesha (PMs):

- +1 if they know how to use Notion

Jacob + Sahil (TL/Engineers):

- Engineer
  - React Experience & General Engineering Experience (classes/internships/projects)
    - Any React experience? Any coding experience? Does their resume link to their projects and if so, do their projects look good? were they just copied from a video or are they original?
    - Have they worked in teams/sprints at all?
- TL
  - Leadership Experience
    - Any leadership experience? Any engineering specific leadership experience?
  - Grasp of language?
- Technical Assessment
  - Functionality: Does it do everything? Only one pokemon is rendered, button has red border when selected, tells you to "select a pokemon" at the start, only one pokeon is displayed, etc
  - Visual: Does it look good/close enough to the Figma? Are all the colors/hover interactions correct? Is the spacing/sizing good? Is there a scroll bar for no reason? Do things shift when you switch between Pokemon or did they keep all the Pokemon images the same size?
  - Code Functionality: Is the code written well? Did they use .map or some other function or did they manually make buttons/cards for each Pokemon? Is the code needlessly complex? Did they use flexbox for css? Is the css short and concise or needlessly complex?
  - Code Appeal: Is code easy to read? Are there comments? Do images have alt tags? Are class names chosen well?

Sheldon (Director of Sourcing):

- Positive things to look for
  - A track record of follow through

    - Excellent communication skills
    - Previously was in a role where they had to communicate with large audiences or email many people (i.e. worked as an intern for someone running for political office)

Changes made:

Removed from Engineer rubric category 4 (review with technical assessment):

-and also exhibit documentation skills (through Github repos or other mediums)

Removed from Engineer rubric category 3 (review with technical assessment):

- "Things stopping a 3 from a 4 would be no prior experience working on teams, **or not exhibiting good documentation skills.**"

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Role Specific Things to Look For (According to respective directors):

Rae (Engineer / Tech Lead):

bullet points for what i was looking for in a resume:

- software position is good (+2); +1 for research
- a personal project is good, but look at it to get an idea (+1)
- good documentation? (+.5)
- proper commits? (+.5)
- [vibey] demonstration of code understanding? (+.5)
- supplemental work position (+.7?)
- Do the bullet points indicate collaboration skills? ability to work well with one another?

bullet points for what i was looking for in an interview:

- can this person do work
- in specific, is this person ready to do technical (web dev) work?
- if they dont know web too well: have they built projects before that indicate a strong cs/making stuff background?
- ability to explain what theyve done technically

- ask/look for specific programming concepts used
- ... like. if you cant explain that a mix of global/private components were what made your project better, and you are trying to tell me communication made it better, then i know it wasnt you who made the call to do that
- if this person is not that advanced: does this person want to grow?
- transparently: what is this persons level and what are they capable of--gauge from previous experience in interview responses
- technically
- teamwork wise
- is this person actually available for the semester
- are they someone i would want to work with
- clear communication
- honesty
- collaboration
- did they demonstrate care/awareness about their team in their answers
- group problem solving ability + can they work technically with others

Katherine [Designers]:

- Creative
- Some artistic ability
- Observant and attention for detail
- Good at problem solving
- Good communicator with the ability to explain complex concepts
- Ability to take criticism and feedback and use it to create a better solution
- Ability to collaborate
- Figma experience is a plus

Brainstorming Area [keep application questions more interesting - leave generic questions to interview when they don't have time to formulate a response] :

Changes Made:

Questions to gauge interest in club:

- Why do you want to join Hack4Impact?
- In your opinion, what differentiates Hack4Impact from other student clubs / opportunities?
- How do you plan on staying involved in Hack4Impact (considering the 5 hour weekly commitment)? [I think I want to put it here not necessarily to read their responses since it probably will be some generic time management stuff, but I want it here so that people are putting more thought into the commitment that they are getting into]

Questions to gauge interest in social good:

- What is a problem affecting others you see that you'd love to use your coding ability to help solve?
- How have you given back to the community recently?
- What is a social initiative you're interested in and how have you contributed?

Got rid of:

Proj Team Q's

- What is your communication style?
- How do you deal with being overwhelmed?

Tech Lead

- The field of software development is always changing. How do you go about staying on top of it?
- How would you respond if a team member suggested using new software, package or framework?

Engineer

- How would you handle getting stuck on a task?

- Tell us about a time you worked on a team.

PM Interview Questions

General (rate 0-4)

- Tell me about yourself
- What do you like to do in your spare time?
- How would you describe your work/life balance?
- Have you ever been in a leadership position before? Can you tell us a bit about it?
- Can you tell us about the last project you worked on?
- Have you ever held a different role in a project team before (either in H4I or in an internship/job/etc)?
- What would you say your greatest weakness is? How have you made an effort to improve on it?
- How much time would you be willing to commit per week to this position?

Behavioral (rate 0-4)

- Give us an example of when you resolved a conflict between teammates.
- Have you ever given the wrong advice to someone in an attempt to solve a conflict? What was the result of that?
- One of your team members is asking for more time to complete a task. How would you handle this situation?
- How would you handle a nonresponsive non-profit partner?
- How would you describe your leadership style?

PM-specific (rate 0-4)

- What do you think it means to be a PM?
- What is a PM's most desirable skill?

- Why do you want this position?
- How does this position fit into your overall career trajectory?
- How do you prioritize tasks in a project?
- How would you create an environment of collaboration on your team?
- Have you ever worked within an agile workflow?